

File No.: EXP202213407

RESOLUTION No.: R/00479/2023

Considering the complaint filed on October 20, 2022, with this Agency by A.A.A. (hereinafter the complainant), against BANCO BILBAO VIZCAYA ARGENTARIA, S.A. (hereinafter the respondent), for not having duly attended to their right of access.

After carrying out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complainant exercised their right of access against the respondent with NIF A48265169, and their request, as stated by the complainant, did not receive the legally established response. They provide various documents related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: In accordance with Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, which has provided a mechanism prior to the admission of complaints filed with the AEPD, consisting of forwarding them to the Data Protection Delegates designated by the controllers or processors of the data, for the purposes provided for in Article 37 of the aforementioned regulation, or to them when they have not been designated, the complaint was forwarded to the respondent entity for analysis and to respond to the complainant and this Agency within one month.

THIRD: The result of the transfer procedure indicated in the previous Fact did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's claims were satisfied. Consequently, on January 20, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data agreed to admit the complaint for processing and informed the parties that the maximum period to resolve this procedure, which is understood to have been initiated by said admission agreement, will be six months.

The aforementioned agreement granted the respondent entity a hearing procedure, so that within ten working days it could present the allegations it deemed appropriate. This entity sent to this Agency a series of documents related to the contractual relationship it maintains with the complainant, such as: Private contract for the sale of a property under construction, an annex with a summary table of the processing of personal data, a declaration of to whom the personal data was transferred. Some of these documents were signed by the complainant.

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FOURTH: The allegations presented by the respondent have been examined and are subject to transfer to the complainant, so that, within fifteen working days, they can formulate any allegations they consider appropriate.

The complainant, in summary, regarding the right of access states that the right has been attended to incompletely.

LEGAL GROUNDS

FIRST: The Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to resolve this matter, in accordance with the provisions of section 2 of Article 56 in relation to section 1 f) of Article 57, both of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of April 27, 2016, on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data (hereinafter, GDPR); and in Article 47 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD).

SECOND: In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among controllers and processors regarding

their obligations, as well as handling complaints filed by a data subject and investigating the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In the case that they have designated a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, prior to the admission of the complaint that gives rise to this procedure, it was forwarded to the responsible entity for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month, and to demonstrate that it had provided the complainant with the due response, in the event of exercising the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR.

This admission agreement determines the opening of the present procedure for lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, according to which:

“1. When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, it will be initiated by an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions of the following article.

In this case, the period for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complainant.”

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procedure. After this period, the interested party may consider their claim accepted.”

It is not deemed appropriate to clarify administrative responsibilities within the framework of a sanctioning procedure, whose exceptional nature implies that, whenever possible, preference should be given to alternative mechanisms that are supported by current regulations.

It is the exclusive competence of this Agency to assess whether there are administrative responsibilities that should be clarified in a sanctioning procedure and, consequently, the decision regarding its initiation, with no obligation to initiate a procedure upon any request made by a third party. Such a decision must be based on the existence of elements that justify the initiation of sanctioning activity, circumstances that do not occur in the present case, considering that with the current procedure, the guarantees and rights of the claimant are duly restored.

THIRD: The rights of individuals regarding the protection of personal data are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, deletion, opposition, the right to limit processing, and the right to portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, consideration is given to what is expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR.

In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the interested party, which will be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the interested party, and to express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the duty to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the controller.

The communication addressed to the interested party regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

Regarding the right of access to personal data, in accordance with the provisions of Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the controller may request the affected party to specify the “data or processing activities to which the request refers.” The right will be understood as granted if the controller provides remote access to the data, considering the request as addressed (although the interested party may request information regarding the aspects provided

for in Article 15 of the GDPR).

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The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive if it is exercised more than once within a period of six months, unless there is a legitimate reason for doing so. On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than the one offered that entails a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

FOURTH: In accordance with the provisions of Article 15 of the GDPR and Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, “the data subject has the right to obtain from the data controller confirmation as to whether or not personal data concerning them is being processed and, if so, the right of access to the personal data.”

Like the other rights of the data subject, the right of access is a personal right. It allows the citizen to obtain information about the processing of their data, the possibility of obtaining a copy of the personal data concerning them that is being processed, as well as information, in particular, about the purposes of the processing, the categories of personal data concerned, the recipients or categories of recipients to whom the personal data have been or will be communicated, the expected retention period or criteria for retention, the possibility of exercising other rights, the right to lodge a complaint with the supervisory authority, the information available about the source of the data (if it has not been obtained directly from the data subject), the existence of automated decision-making, including profiling, and information about transfers of personal data to a third country or to an international organization.

The possibility of obtaining a copy of the personal data being processed will not negatively affect the rights and freedoms of others.

In the case analyzed here, the claimant exercised their right of access and the respondent initially states that they do not have data regarding this matter despite exchanging documentation related to the contractual relationship they maintain, where the bank is a guarantor for the claimant. Later, throughout the procedure, they send this Agency various documents but do not prove to have fully addressed the right as established by the aforementioned regulations.

Furthermore, most of the documentation provided by the respondent in their allegations contains the claimant's signature, so it is to be assumed that they already have it or at least know of its existence. It remains mostly documentation resulting from their contractual relationship.

We conclude, with the documentation on record in the procedure, as derived from the allegations made and the documentation provided by the respondent in the process of transferring the complaint, that the access granted by the respondent entity is incomplete and that it is not documented that it has been sent to the claimant.

In view of the cited provisions and others of general application, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the complaint made by A.A.A. and to instruct BANCO BILBAO VIZCAYA ARGENTARIA, S.A. with NIF A48265169, to send, within ten working days following the notification of this resolution, to the claimant a certification addressing the requested right of access or to deny it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be granted, in accordance with the provisions set forth in this resolution. The actions taken as a result of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same timeframe. Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to BANCO BILBAO VIZCAYA ARGENTARIA, S.A. In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested

parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and Section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law. 1037-160523

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